

Note!

HFS We don't recommend formatting your hard drive partitions or RAM Disk with HFS because you won't be able to access these drives from older (ProDOS 8) programs and because access will be slower than ProDOS format. We suggest initializing only 3.5" disks in HFS format, and only if they will be used to exchange data with Macintosh programs.

Note!

If you're making a new startup disk for your computer, it must be initialized in ProDOS format. You can't start up the computer from a HFS disk.

4:1 = 11C Finally, select the interleave (initialization operations only—you don't have this choice when erasing a disk). If you're making a new HFS disk which will be used primarily on the Macintosh, select 2:1. If you're making a new HFS disk and will be using it heavily on the IIGS, select 4:1. If you're creating a ProDOS disk, select 2:1 except in the rare circumstance that you have (or will be using the disk on) an Apple UniDisk 3.5 drive (the *white* Apple 3.5" drive usually used on the Apple IIc)—in that case, select 4:1. (The interleave option adjusts the disk's formatting so that it can be accessed most rapidly on the machine it will be used on most of the time.)

Note!

If you're unsure which format or interleave or disk format to choose, just accept the dialog as it is. The default settings will work for most users.

By The Way...

You can't change a disk's interleave without reformatting it. If you need to change a disk's interleave for better performance on another system, format a new disk with the desired interleave and copy the old disk's contents to the new disk.

Initialization (or erasure) will begin when you click the "Initialize" or "Erase" button at the bottom of the dialog (or press ⌘-Return). Erasing a disk takes only a few seconds; initializing can take a minute or so. When the operation is complete, the new disk will appear on the desktop.

By The Way...

It is sometimes possible to recover data from disks that have been accidentally erased (not initialized) using utilities like ProSel-16 or Salvation-Deliverance. Don't count on it, though—always make sure you don't need any of the information on a disk before erasing it.

Note!

We suggest using the Initialize option when reusing older disks. The Initialize option will rewrite and verify every part of the disk to make sure it's still good. Additionally, initialization makes sure that the interleave on the disk is set for maximum access efficiency.